DATA VALIDATION

Excel has a feature that allows you to validate the data you enter into the cells in an Excel Worksheet. Data validation enables you to establish rules for data entry in a cell, and then Excel will check the data entered against those rules. You can choose from several options depending on what you want to do with the data. The essence is to ensure the data entered is accurate and conforms to specific rules.

For example, you can prevent someone else from entering invalid data into a worksheet you are working on. In another way, you can allow other users who have access to your worksheet only to be able to enter numbers in a specific range. This can be done by setting up rules restricting the cell only to accept numbers within that range. Excel won't allow it if someone tries entering a value outside your set range. You can also make Excel show a warning sign if someone else tries to break the rules you have set on your worksheet. This way, other users with access to your worksheet can still enter the data they want, but they'll be warned if it doesn't meet a specified criteria. You can also set up an error message when someone enters invalid data, which is a helpful way to let those with access know what went wrong and what they need to do to fix it.